

Scott Gerstl

Senior Design Leader | Enterprise SaaS, AI Product Design, Design Systems

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SUMMARY

Senior product design leader with 15 years shipping enterprise SaaS at scale, plus a recent year of consumer AI products designed, built, and shipped solo. Player-coach who builds and scales high-performance design teams (7+ designers at Brightly/Siemens) while staying hands-on with the craft. Deep experience in AI product design, design systems, design operations, and translating complex workflows into intuitive, polished experiences. Currently building AI products independently in Berlin and consulting on AI agent surface design for a sim racing telemetry product, bringing a transparency-for-trust pattern to the user-AI handoff.

EXPERIENCE

Independent Product Designer — Self-Employed

Aug 2025 – Present · Berlin, DE

- Reframed a sim-racing telemetry product as an agentic AI workspace for behavioral data interpretation. Built interactive HTML prototypes of analytical archetypes to improve user performance; the client returned for a second paid engagement (in progress) covering telemetry visualization and the onboarding funnel.
- Designed and built Cal, an AI personal training app with voice-guided workouts; research to live app for real users in five days, with AI as design deliverable, builder, and product feature.
- Designed and built Epilog, an AI-powered health tracking app that uses Claude to analyze seizure patterns and surface actionable insights from patient data.
- Created the Employment Panopticon system: a personal knowledge platform with an integrated AI assistant, automated reminders pipeline, and a job intelligence agent that monitors and evaluates opportunities.
- Working hands-on across the full stack: UX research, interaction design, front-end development (Next.js, React, Tailwind, Supabase), and AI prompt architecture.

Senior Manager of UX Design — Industrial

Jan 2024 – Jul 2025 · Raleigh, NC, USA

- Architected automation for high-density energy data; transitioned manual monitoring to autonomous, observability-first systems. *Impact:* Reduced manual monitoring time by 25% and increased curtailment accuracy by 30%.
- Directed Yard Management System (YMS) design via on-site field research; synchronized physical operational workflows with digital tracking. *Impact:* Generated a new Energy-as-a-Service revenue stream; reduced fuel costs and enabled Scope 3 reporting for carriers.
- Embedded rapid research and usability testing into agile development cycles; created and governed design system and processes. *Impact:* Reduced design-to-engineering handoff churn by 20%.

Product Design Manager and Lead Product Designer — Brightly (a Siemens Company)

Mar 2016 – Dec 2023 · Raleigh, NC, USA

- Directed design strategy through a \$1.575B acquisition by Siemens and developed a long-term product integration plan. *Impact:* Reduced annual licensing costs by \$10K/yr and enabled cross-selling opportunities valued at ~\$2M ARR.
- Built and led the Brightly design team: hired, coached, and developed 7+ designers across UX, UI, and research; implemented career ladders and mentorship programs. *Impact:* Achieved lowest team attrition rate in the company.
- Rolled out and governed a unified design system across 12 SaaS products serving manufacturing, education, healthcare, and government clients. *Impact:* Reduced frontend rework and handoff time by ~20%.
- Redesigned the core asset management module for improved user flow and UI. *Impact:* 20% reduction in support calls and 15% increase in user task completion.

UX Designer — Teradata

Mar 2015 – Feb 2016 · Raleigh, NC, USA

- Moderated usability testing and executed visual QA for interaction pattern and style guide compliance across digital marketing suites.

UX Designer — Tyler Technologies

May 2012 – Mar 2015 · Raleigh, NC, USA

- Designed complex, multi-step interfaces for government licensing; managed high-stakes regulatory requirements and business rules. *Impact:* Reduced state inspection processing time by 50% through comprehensive paper-to-digital transformation.

EDUCATION

- Master of Education — Lesley University, Cambridge, MA · BA, English Literature — University at Albany, NY · Certified Usability Analyst (CUA), Human Factors International

SKILLS

- Design Leadership:** Team Management, Hiring, Mentorship, Career Development, Design Operations, Stakeholder Engagement, Budgeting
- Design Strategy:** UX Strategy, Product Strategy, Design Systems, AI Product Design, Service Design, Enterprise SaaS
- Methods:** User Research, Usability Testing, Design Sprints, Prototyping, Information Architecture, Interaction Design, Visual Design, Data Visualization, Accessibility (WCAG)
- AI & Development:** Claude API, Prompt Architecture, AI-assisted Workflows, Design-to-Code Workflows, Next.js, React, Tailwind, Supabase
- Tools:** Figma, Figma Make, Cursor, Claude Code, Google Stitch, Miro, GitHub
- Languages:** English (Native), German (A2, in Integrationskurs), Spanish (A2)